

Amazon PPC Cheat Sheet

Metric Formulas

CTR = (Clicks / Impressions) x 100 | Healthy: 0.25-0.50%+
CPC = Spend / Clicks | Healthy: \$0.50-\$2.50
CVR = (Orders / Clicks) x 100 | Healthy: 5-15%+
ACoS = (Spend / Ad Sales) x 100 | Target: 10-35%
ROAS = Ad Sales / Spend | Healthy: 3.0-10.0+
TACoS = (Spend / Total Revenue) x 100 | Healthy: 5-15%

Optimization Rules

- 10-15+ clicks, 0 orders -> NEGATIVE keyword
- 3+ orders, ACoS <= target -> PROMOTE to Exact
- ACoS well below target -> INCREASE bid 10-20%
- ACoS above target, 10+ clicks -> DECREASE bid 10-20%
- Never change bids by more than 20% at once
- Review search term report every 3-7 days
- Always document changes: date, term, action, reason

Campaign Structure (4 Layers)

1. Discovery (Auto+Broad) - ~30% budget - find new terms
2. Expansion (Phrase) - ~20% budget - scale promising terms
3. Heroes (Exact) - ~40% budget - max profit on best keywords
4. Defense & Conquest (ASIN+SD) - ~10% budget - defend/attack

Match Types

- Auto: Amazon decides based on listing. Widest reach.
- Broad: Variations & synonyms. Word order doesn't matter.
- Phrase: Must include keyword in order. Words can be added.
- Exact: Only that keyword + close variants. Tightest control.

Bid Strategies

- Dynamic Down Only: AI can lower bids. For new/untested keywords.
- Dynamic Up & Down: AI can raise+lower. For proven keywords.
- Fixed Bids: No AI changes. Rare in 2026.
- Placement Multiplier: +X% for top of search or product pages.

Naming Convention

[Product] - [Ad Type] - [Match Type] - [Purpose]

Examples:

WaterBottle - SP - Auto - Discovery
WaterBottle - SP - Exact - Heroes
WaterBottle - SB - Video - Brand
WaterBottle - SD - ASIN - Conquest

Common Negative Keywords

free, cheap, used, broken, parts, repair, how to, DIY, replacement, wholesale, used

Launch vs Scale

- Launch (Days 1-30): ACoS 30-50% OK. More Discovery budget.
- Scale (Day 30+): ACoS 15-25%. Shift to Heroes. Tighten negatives.
- Watch TACoS trend: falling TACoS = healthy scaling.